

February

27

1594

Henry of Bourbon

Henry IV became the first noble from the House of Bourbon to be crowned king of France. His coronation marked the beginning of one of the most influential dynasties in Europe. The monarch brought peace and progress to France, earning him the nickname “Good King Henry”.



Born this day

1956 Meena Keshwar Kamal, Afghan activist. She established the Revolutionary Association of the Women of Afghanistan to promote the rights and education of women. She founded schools for refugee women and their children.

1998

Costly cake

The most expensive slice of wedding cake sold for US \$29,900 at a Sotheby's auction in New York, USA, more than 60 years after it was baked. It was made in 1937 for the wedding reception of the Duke and Duchess of Windsor. The money raised at this sale was given to charity.



Also on this day

1844 The Dominican Republic began a 12-year struggle for independence from Haiti on the Caribbean island of Hispaniola.

1947 British physicist **James Stanley Hey** discovered that the Sun emits radio waves.

1999 Millions queued at polling stations in Nigeria to elect a civilian president and replace 15 years of military rule with a democratic government.

Burning of Parliament

1933

The German Parliament building, known as the Reichstag, was set on fire in a deliberate attack. Nazi leader Adolf Hitler blamed the fire on his communist opponents and used it as an opportunity to increase his own power.

